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19 October 2026

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Senior Data Engineer role at Brightwell Analytics (reference BW-DE-0417). I am a data engineer of 7 years' experience with a background in retail and logistics data. In my current role I moved the nightly rebuild of our delivery-performance mart to incremental dbt models and cut it from 6 hours to 55 minutes, and I introduced Great Expectations tests on 30 core tables, after which failed loads fell by 70 percent over two quarters. Those are the kind of outcomes I would like to help produce on the forecast pipelines Brightwell runs every night.

I now own a shipment-events pipeline that carries 40 million events per day, orchestrated with Apache Airflow. Earlier, at Marlow Retail Group, I built the company's first Airflow deployment and migrated 45 cron jobs onto it, and designed a customer-orders star schema in PostgreSQL used by 12 analysts. For your nice-to-haves, I work with Kafka in production and mentor two junior engineers while leading the weekly data-modelling review.

I want to be plain about Scala and Spark: I do not have hands-on experience with either. My work has been in Python, with Kafka streaming, Python ingestion services (about 2 million rows a day at Marlow) and warehouse transformations in SQL and dbt rather than Spark jobs. The incremental dbt work and the Kafka pipeline are the closest experience I have to the heavy transformations you describe; I would be willing to learn Spark and Scala from there.

I should also say where my experience stops short of your description. I have not worked with data scientists to get their features into production, and my data quality work has been Great Expectations tests on 30 core tables rather than systematic monitoring and ownership for every table.

I am based in Rotterdam and open to your hybrid setup in Amsterdam. I would welcome the chance to talk about the platform team and where these gaps matter most.

Kind regards,
Alex Fernsby